

other things. She also told me that her husband had never purchased a new car in the thirty years that they had been married. Apparently, he is in a semi-constant search for real deals on automobiles. He is particularly prone to purchasing quality used Japanese and German vehicles. But he is absolutely never in a hurry to make such purchases. Like many people in the used vehicle-prone shopper group, he gets immense pleasure from finding good deals from private sellers with too much car, too little capital.

I suspect that is why he spent time debriefing me. He asked me what I did for a living. He asked me how well my business was operating. Perhaps he had thought I was an out-of-work corporate executive. Why else would I be at home in the middle of the afternoon in my khaki pants and flannel shirt? I told him I was an author, working on book number four. Then he inquired about how well my other books were selling. “Great,” I answered. He then frowned and asked the question of questions: “Would you be interested in knocking \$1,500 off the asking price?” Again I responded, “Perhaps in thirty days if I don’t sell it before then.” I am still waiting to hear from him, too! He did seem impressed with the way I maintained automobiles, so just before he left, he asked if I intended to sell any of my other cars. He pointed to my high-performance Z28 Camaro. I had to turn him down on that offer, too.

Shopper Four: a schoolteacher, female

Isn’t it interesting that a disproportionately high number of used-car shoppers come from the ranks of teachers and professors? Shopper Four called me late one Friday evening. (When do weekend telephone rates go into effect?) She had a battery of questions to ask me. After this intense debriefing, she informed me that she lived several hundred miles from Atlanta in “cotton” country. She said she was in the process of calling many of the people who had listed Acura Legends in the Atlanta classifieds.

She promised to get back in touch with me the following Wednesday. She kept her promise and asked if I could fax her evidence that there were no outstanding liens on the vehicle. She also asked if it would be possible to have a more detailed list of the car’s accessories. I faxed her the title and a copy of the original window sticker, with prices and options. She then advised me that she planned to come to Atlanta that Friday and look at several vehicles that were for sale.